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Top Skills

AI Consulting & Integration
Employee Learning & Development
Research Skills

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)
Portuguese (Native or Bilingual)
Italian (Professional Working)

Certifications

Certified Scrum Product Owner
Certified Mindfulness Coach
Certified Workplace Happiness
Specialist
The Power Business School -

Marco Martins

AI Consulting & Integration | Helping Engineering Teams Build
Genuine AI Capability
Greater Braga Area

Summary

My technical roots are in safety-critical automotive systems. Over time I shifted toward what happens when you put the right learning conditions around an engineering team — and how quickly they can grow when those conditions are right. I've built technical learning programmes at global scale, coached engineering teams through Agile transformations, and taught Embedded Systems and Digital Systems with a hands-on, project-based approach — always connecting engineering depth with business value. I'm currently completing the Ironhack AI Consulting; Integration bootcamp — working hands-on with the latest AI development tools and frameworks — and applying that directly to how engineering organisations can build genuine AI capability, not just AI awareness. I'm mission-driven. If there's no clear purpose behind the work, it's not the right fit. If there is, I bring everything I have. I work at the intersection of technology, learning, and human performance. If that's where you're building something, let's connect.

Experience

Instituto Politécnico do Cávado e do Ave
Invited Lecturer - Digital Systems, Microcontrollers, Embedded Systems
February 2015 - Present (11 years 2 months)
Braga, Braga, Portugal

I teach Digital Systems, Microcontrollers Programming, and Embedded Systems to CTeSP students, with a hands-on, lab-first approach. I care less about memorisation and more about understanding — how systems work, why they fail, and how to design solutions that hold up in the real world.

Beyond the technical content, I support students in navigating the transition from academic life to professional practice — building confidence, direction, and readiness for industry.

The measure of success I care about most is not grades — it is students who leave with clarity, confidence, and job offers from the organisations where they trained.

Freelance

12 years 7 months

Career Coach

September 2013 - Present (12 years 7 months)

Worldwide

Alongside my other professional activities, I take on engagements with young and early-career engineers navigating the transition from university to industry — helping them find clarity, build confidence, and make career decisions that are technically grounded and personally aligned.

The challenges I focus on are the ones that rarely appear in engineering curricula: self-doubt, lack of direction, communication, and the gap between technical knowledge and professional reality. I have also delivered workshops and speaking engagements at universities, working with student branches and engineering communities on these same topics.

The outcome I work toward is engineers who take ownership of their careers — not just following market trends, but building paths that are sustainable and meaningful. Every coaching process is tailored to the individual — no templates, no generic advice.

Training & Agile Consultant

October 2017 - December 2017 (3 months)

Braga, Portugal

Short-term consulting engagements focused on training and learning strategy design, Scrum coaching, and team and work organisation.

Oficina de Competências

Business Partner

February 2023 - October 2023 (9 months)

Braga, Portugal

Working alongside the founder, I helped redefine the business model and strategy of this HR consultancy specialising in training, coaching, and mentoring. This involved redesigning the company's service offering, rebuilding the website, developing workshop and webinar templates, and shaping the overall business communication strategy.

A short but focused engagement — bringing together my experience in learning design, coaching, and business development to help build a more coherent and scalable operation.

IVV Automation / Caixiave / University of Minho Partnership
Project Manager & Team Leader — NanoPlus Window
January 2018 - June 2021 (3 years 6 months)
Braga, Portugal

Led the project management and team leadership of an R&D initiative developing an intelligent window system for energy-efficient buildings. The solution integrated a mechatronic control system with cloud-based management, enabling remote and automated control of all window components — ventilation and air purification. Local device communication was handled via Z-Wave protocol.

Coordinated a multidisciplinary consortium bringing together industry partners IVV Automation and Caixiave alongside the University of Minho — managing technical workstreams and leading the coordination of technical report writing.

Bosch Car Multimedia / University of Minho Partnership
Agile & Scrum Coach (Automotive HMI Systems)
June 2014 - September 2017 (3 years 4 months)
Guimarães

Led and coached an engineering team working on cutting-edge automotive Human-Machine Interface concepts — touch screens, gesture sensors, Head-Up Displays, and eye trackers — as part of a partnership between Bosch Car Multimedia and the University of Minho.

I guided the team through a full Agile and Scrum adoption, building the practices, culture, and self-organisation that drove measurable improvements in productivity and collaboration. The team grew from 7 to 22 members following a new project award in 2015, a direct reflection of the confidence the organisation had in what we were building together.

When I left, the team didn't need replacing. That remains the outcome I'm most proud of.

Freelance
E-Learning Project Manager & Instructional Designer
June 2012 - July 2013 (1 year 2 months)
Europe

Led a major e-learning project for a large international food company — end to end, from requirements gathering and module prototyping through to final delivery.

Developed a comprehensive onboarding programme and tools introduction for new HR employees, delivered in English, Italian, and French. Coordinated with professional translators across all three languages to ensure consistency and quality throughout.

Atmel Corporation

5 years 5 months

Corporate Training Manager (Atmel Academy)

January 2009 - May 2012 (3 years 5 months)

Trondheim, Norway

Built and led Atmel Academy — the company's global technical learning platform — from the ground up. Designed and developed the e-learning infrastructure, content strategy, and delivery processes that served the worldwide sales team, field engineers, and partners.

Led a distributed team of e-learning developers across five locations in four countries, establishing a unified design process that brought consistency and quality to content production at scale.

The Atmel Academy delivered over 100 e-learning modules and more than 80 sales webinars, building a learning curriculum that reached over 2500 users and a platform serving 5000+ users across 40+ countries.

This remains one of the clearest examples of what I build — learning ecosystems that scale without losing quality.

AVR University Program Manager

January 2007 - December 2009 (3 years)

Trondheim, Norway

Led the global AVR University Program — building and managing a worldwide network of academic institutions integrating AVR microcontrollers into their engineering curricula. Grew the programme to over 800 universities across 100+ countries, establishing partnerships with institutions including MIT, Cornell, University of Wisconsin-Madison, and NTNU.

Developed the tools, resources, and support structures that made AVR microcontrollers the reference platform for embedded systems education globally. Also sponsored the MIT Solar Challenge, showcasing real-world AVR applications to the next generation of engineers.

A role that shaped how I think about scaling technical knowledge — not through broadcasting, but through building communities of practice.

Bentley Motors Ltd

Project Engineer (Tyre Pressure Monitoring Systems)

March 2004 - December 2006 (2 years 10 months)

Crewe, England

Responsible for the development and integration of Tyre Pressure Monitoring Systems (TPMS) into the Bentley Continental model range — from concept through to production across three model years (MY2004, MY2005, MY2006).

The work spanned system validation across varying road conditions and climates throughout Europe and the United States, development of a production line diagnostic system, and design of a bespoke Bentley TPMS Human-Machine Interface — balancing technical precision with the experience expectations of a luxury vehicle.

Delivered on time, to quality, across three consecutive model years.

Brembo S.p.A.

Senior Systems Engineer / Team Leader (Brake-by-Wire)

April 2001 - February 2004 (2 years 11 months)

Bergamo, Italy

Led an international engineering team developing advanced mechatronic brake systems — Brake-by-Wire and Electric Park Brake — for automotive applications. The work covered the full systems engineering cycle: architecture definition, requirements management, risk analysis, software development, and validation.

Delivered an Integrated Brake Control Unit featuring Time Triggered Protocol communication networks, working closely with the main customer Peugeot/Citroën and managing supplier relationships throughout. A technically demanding programme delivered to quality and customer satisfaction in a safety-critical environment.

Pi Shurlok

Software Engineer (Engine Management Systems)

June 2000 - March 2001 (10 months)

Cambridge, United Kingdom & Detroit, USA

Contributed to the development of engine management software, working on control strategies for fuel efficiency, air management, and emissions reduction.

Based across Cambridge and Detroit, the role involved close collaboration with an engine manufacturer partner to ensure regulatory compliance while pushing performance boundaries.

A short but formative experience working on complex, real-world control systems at the intersection of software and mechanical engineering.

TRW Automotive

Electronics Engineer (Automotive Brake Systems)

September 1998 - May 2000 (1 year 9 months)

Fen End, England & Koblenz, Germany

Designed and tested software algorithms for electronic brake systems, with a focus on performance, reliability, and safety.

Evaluated testing tools and techniques, providing recommendations that improved the team's development process.

Also developed diagnostics strategies and algorithms that enhanced system reliability in production.

An early-career role that established the foundations of my systems engineering approach — rigorous, safety-focused, and grounded in real-world constraints.

Cranfield University / SAB Pipeline

Research Engineer — Welding Robotics & Neural Networks

March 1997 - August 1998 (1 year 6 months)

Cranfield

What started as an internship became a research scholarship. Initially commissioned and programmed a set of ABB robots for pipeline welding operations serving the North Sea oil industry, in partnership with specialist company SAB Pipeline.

The work then evolved into research applying neural networks to welding parameter optimisation and robot control — work that earned an MPhil in Welding & Robotics Technology from Cranfield University.

Looking back, this was my first encounter with AI — using neural networks to solve a real industrial problem, long before the term became mainstream.

Education

Cranfield University

MPhil, Welding & Robotics Technology · (1997 - 2000)

ThePowerMBA

Master of Business Administration - MBA · (2021 - 2022)

Universidade do Minho

Licentiate degree (5 years), Industrial Electronics Engineering · (1992 - 1997)

Escola Secundaria Carlos Amarante

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